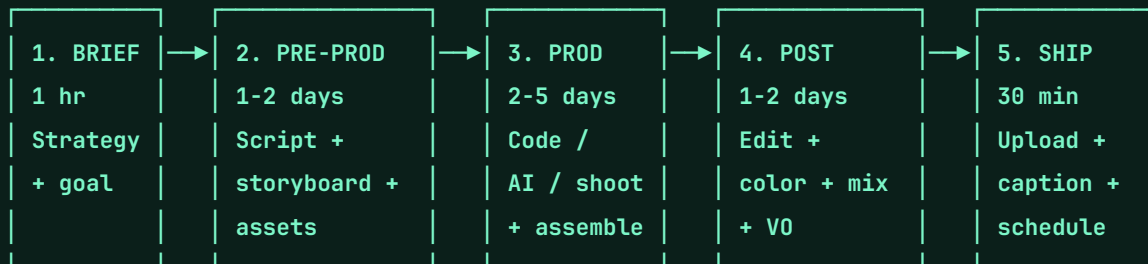


Brand Mint — Video Production Workflow

The complete playbook from blank brief to published reel.

Version 1.0 · 2026-05-24 · maintained on `claude/social-media-video-generation-Mj4u6`

At a glance



Total per reel: 4-10 working days, depending on complexity.

Premium reel (client work): 7-12 days. **Studio reel (internal):** 3-5 days.

Phase 1 — Brief (1 hour)

The single most important hour of the entire production. Mistakes here cost days later.

Inputs needed

- Audience: who is this for?
- Goal: save · share · click · DM · follow?
- Track: A (real-estate marketing) or B (software/dev)?
- Pillar: which of the 6 content pillars from `INSTAGRAM-BRIEF.md` ?
- Format: Reel / Carousel / Single static / Story-poll?
- Constraints: brand rules, hard avoids (see `INSTAGRAM-BRIEF.md`)
- Deadline + posting slot

Owner

Strategy / Creative Director (currently: founder).

Deliverable

A 1-page brief committed to `brand-kit/content/briefs/.md`. Template:

```
# Brief – <post slug>

- Date: <ISO date>
- Pillar: <which of the 6>
- Format: <reel | carousel | static | story-poll>
- Length: <e.g., 19s reel · 8-slide carousel>
- DM keyword: <e.g., 'AUDIT' or 'POSITION'>
- Primary KPI: <save-rate | share-rate | DM volume | follower delta>

## Audience
- Primary: <e.g., Hyderabad real-estate builder marketing heads>
- Secondary: <e.g., property buyers / investors as echo>

## Hook (3 candidates)
1. <line 1>
2. <line 2>
3. <line 3>

## Single sentence summary
<one line – what's the post about>

## Hard avoids
- <e.g., no invented numbers, no founder face>
```

Quality gate

- ✓ Hook is concrete (no agency jargon · no "elevate" · no "compound" without specificity)
- ✓ KPI is measurable
- ✓ Audience is one segment, not three
- ✓ Goal is one action, not three

Phase 2 — Pre-Production (1–2 days)

2.1 Script

For reels, script the **on-screen text** + **VO** + **timing** on one page. Use this format (see [brand-kit/video/v16-cinematic/VO-SCRIPT.md](#) for a worked example):

```
# Script – <post slug>
```

```
| Time | Beat | On-screen | VO (if any) | Visual notes |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| 0:00-0:01 | open | (silent – logo mark) | – | M-monogram draws on |
| 0:01-0:03 | hook | "POSITIONING IS / THE ONLY MARKETING / THAT COMPOUNDS." | "Positioning... is the o
| 0:03-0:05 | pain1 | "ADS END." | "Ads end." | Drop-in, particle field |
| 0:05-0:07 | payoff1 | "POSITIONS STAY." | "Positions stay." | Whip-pan in, mint highlight |
| ... | ... | ... | ... | ... |
| 0:15-0:19 | CTA | 'COMMENT "POSITION"' | "Comment 'position' – we'll DM your category gap." | Mint ba
```

2.2 Storyboard

A frame-by-frame sketch in Figma (or a 9-cell grid on paper). Each cell = one beat. Annotate:

- Camera framing (wide / medium / close)
- Composition (centered / off-set / split)
- Color emphasis (mint pillar / black field / yellow accent)
- Transition in/out (fade / whip / glitch / drop)

2.3 Asset prep

ASSET	SOURCE	QUALITY BAR
Logo / mark	brand-kit/logo/brand-mint-monogram.svg (canonical, do not redraw)	Pixel-identical to source
Typography	Plus Jakarta Sans + JetBrains Mono (in brand-kit/fonts/)	Use ONLY these
Color palette	BRAND-GUIDELINES.md §3	Mint-3 (#10B981) primary
Music	Musicbed / Artlist	Licensed only — never YouTube rips
SFX	Splice / freesound.org	CC0 or licensed
Stock footage	Artgrid / Filmsupply	4K, ungraded

Owner

Creative Director + Motion Designer.

Quality gate

- ✓ Script reads aloud in under target duration (×1.1 buffer for VO breath)
 - ✓ Storyboard has 6+ frames for a 20s reel (one per beat)
 - ✓ Every visual asset cited in script is in `brand-kit/`
-

Phase 3 — Production (2–5 days)

Four production paths. Pick based on the brief.

3.A Code-rendered (our `v13 / v14 / v15 / v16` system)

When: editorial reels, builder spotlights, manifesto posts, data carousels — anywhere you need:

- Pixel-perfect typography
- Repeatable brand application
- Fast iteration (5-10 min per render)
- Free

How:

1. Branch off existing build script (e.g. `build_cinematic.py`)
2. Edit the `BEATS` list (the script's storyboard in code form)
3. Update palette only if needed (default to brand mint)
4. Run `python3 build_.py`
5. Output goes to `out/-bpm.mp4`

Files:

- `brand-kit/video/v16-cinematic/build_cinematic.py` — Hollywood-tier reference
- `brand-kit/video/v13-hyderabad-empires/build_*.py` — editorial reference

Owner: Engineer / motion designer with Python knowledge.

3.B AI-generated (Higgsfield + Runway + Kling)

When: brand-reveal moments, cinematic b-roll, hero shots, product close-ups — where code can't produce the look.

How:

1. **Higgsfield** (\$30-50/mo) — upload a still image, pick a camera move preset (dolly zoom / parallax / crash zoom / orbit). Export as 5-10s MP4. **Best for:** brand reveal moments, logo treatments, stylized product hero shots.

2. **Runway Gen-3 Alpha** (\$35-95/mo) — text→video or image→video. **Best for:** AI b-roll for cutaways (e.g. "Hyderabad skyline at dusk, cinematic, anamorphic, 2k").

3. **Kling 2.0** (\$10-20/mo) — short cinematic clips with physically-grounded motion. **Best for:** product / hand / object shots where physics matters.

4. **Sora** (ChatGPT Pro \$200/mo) — highest quality, when accessible.

Output: drop the AI clips into `brand-kit/video/v/_/assets/ai/` for the editor to compose with.

Owner: Creative Director picks the look; AE/Premiere editor composites.

3.C Live shoot

When: client-led, founder testimonials, product launches, locations. **Avoid for cold-start brand content** (brief bans founder face).

Gear minimum for cinema-grade output:

- Camera: Sony FX3 (rent ₹3-5K/day) or iPhone 15 Pro (free, very capable)
- Lens: 35mm + 85mm primes
- Lighting: 2× Aputure 60d + softbox + reflector
- Audio: Rode Wireless Pro or Lavalier — never camera mic
- Tripod + monitor

Hyderabad rental: Photoquip, Imagic, Lensbug — ₹3K-10K/day full kit.

Owner: Producer + DOP.

3.D Hybrid (most production reels)

Default mix: **code-rendered base** (text + brand frames) + **AI cutaways** (Higgsfield brand-reveal, Runway b-roll) + **stock footage** (Artgrid hero shots) + **live elements** (if applicable).

Assemble in After Effects or Premiere.

Quality gate (all paths)

- ✓ Every text line fits within `SAFE_TEXT_W = 920` (`SPACING-GUIDELINES.md`)
- ✓ Mark uses canonical `brand-mint-monogram.svg` (don't redraw)
- ✓ Music has license proof (Musicbed receipt / Artist track ID)
- ✓ AI clips have prompt + tool noted in `_assets/manifest.md`

Phase 4 — Post-Production (1–2 days)

4.1 Edit

Cut to the music. **Beats first, dialogue second, visuals third.** Tools:

- **DaVinci Resolve** (free) — best for color + edit + Fusion motion graphics
- **CapCut Desktop** (free) — fastest for Reel-style cuts, auto-captions
- **Premiere Pro** (\$23/mo) — industry default if hiring freelancers

Cuts every 1.0-1.8s for high-retention reels (per [PLAYBOOK-VIRAL-REELS.md](#) §1 mechanic #7).

4.2 Color grade

For code-rendered reels: skip (palette is already brand-locked).

For AI/shot footage: use DaVinci Resolve.

- Target: warm-black background [#070A09](#) ground · mint [#10B981](#) accents
- LUT: build a "Brand Mint" LUT once (.cube file) and apply to all footage
- Match grade across clips before final export

4.3 Sound design

Layer the audio in this order (top to bottom = quietest to loudest in mix):

1. **Background music bed** — at -18 dB during VO, -10 dB without
2. **Sub thumps** — on every beat-change cut (-12 dB)
3. **Whoosh transitions** — on whip-pans and scene breaks (-9 dB)
4. **Voice-over** — at -6 dB peak (always the loudest single element)
5. **Bell / impact accents** — on brand reveals (-9 dB)

4.4 Voice-over

Decision tree:

- **Skip VO entirely** (default for editorial/Pentagram-tier reels) → strongest brand move at cold-start
- **AI placeholder** (ElevenLabs Sarah, \$22/mo) → for client review only, never ship
- **Real human** (Fiverr ₹500-3K, or local studio ₹2-5K/hr) → for any reel that will run paid

If using VO, post-process:

- High-pass 80 Hz · gentle boost 3-5 kHz · de-ess at 7 kHz
- Compress at 3:1 ratio with -18 dB threshold
- Final pass through Auphonic.com (free for short clips) for auto-loudness

4.5 Captions

Burn-in captions for accessibility + sound-off viewing. CapCut auto-captions are 90% accurate — manually fix the brand words (BrandMint, mint, Hyderabad, builder names).

Style: white fill + 4px black stroke, position 70-80% Y, font-size 56-64px, font Inter Bold.

4.6 Master export

Final spec for Instagram Reels:

```
Resolution:    1080 × 1920 (9:16)
Codec:         H.264 high profile L4.0
Bitrate:       ≥10 Mbps
Frame rate:    30 fps (60fps allowed but IG normalizes)
Audio:         AAC stereo 192 kbps
Loudness:      -14 LUFS integrated
Color:         Rec.709
Container:     .mp4 with +faststart
```

Quality gate

- ✓ Master plays correctly on iPhone Safari + Android Chrome
- ✓ Text never overlaps IG UI overlays (top 250px / bottom 340px)
- ✓ Audio levels match Instagram (-14 LUFS)
- ✓ Watch from start to end without pause — does it land?

Phase 5 — Ship (30 min)

5.1 Review

- **Internal review:** play once at full volume on phone (not desktop). Identify the one moment that feels weakest. Fix it.
- **Client review** (if applicable): upload to **Frame.io** (\$15/mo per seat). Client adds time-coded comments. Address each.

5.2 Caption + meta

Copy the caption from `brand-kit/content/posts-ready//caption.txt`. Verify:

- First line mirrors the hook (so IG feed preview shows the hook)
- DM keyword in CAPS in caption
- 15-20 hashtags at the end after `. \n. \n. \n` breathing dots

5.3 Cover frame

For Reels: pick a hero frame (mid-brand-reveal usually best). Save as 1080×1920 JPG. In IG: when uploading the Reel, tap "Cover" → "Add from camera roll" → pick the JPG.

5.4 Schedule

Use the time recommendation from `meta.txt`. Post manually at the recommended slot, or use **Meta Business Suite** (free) to schedule.

5.5 Engage

Within 30 min of posting:

- Reply to every comment for the first hour (algo signal)
 - DM the answer for everyone who uses the DM keyword
 - Pin the strongest comment
-

The tool stack — full reference

Software (monthly cost)

CATEGORY	TOOL	COST (₹)	COST (\$)	CRITICAL?
Music license	Musicbed	₹2,500	\$30	YES — single biggest "premium" lift
AI camera moves	Higgsfield	₹2,500-4,000	\$30-50	High-leverage from month 2
AI video	Runway Gen-3	₹3,000-8,000	\$35-95	Month 2+
AI video (premium)	Sora (ChatGPT Pro)	₹17,000	\$200	Month 6+
AI voice (drafts)	ElevenLabs Creator	₹1,800	\$22	Optional
Stock footage	Artgrid	₹2,000	\$25	Month 2+
SFX library	Splice Sounds	₹850	\$10	Month 2+
Editing	Adobe Creative Cloud	₹4,700	\$55	Month 2+ if hiring AE designer
Color grading	DaVinci Resolve	₹0	\$0	Always (free)
Editing (free)	CapCut Desktop	₹0	\$0	Always (free)
Client review	Frame.io	₹1,300/seat	\$15	Month 3+ when serving clients
Project mgmt	Notion	₹0-700	\$0-8	Always

Cold-start budget (Month 1): ₹2,500-5,000/mo (Musicbed + optional ElevenLabs)

Production tier (Month 3): ₹10,000-15,000/mo

Studio tier (Month 6+): ₹30,000-60,000/mo

Hardware (one-time)

FOR	ITEM	COST (₹)
Voice-over recording	Shure SM7B + Cloudlifter + Focusrite Scarlett 2i2	₹65-75K
OR	Rode PodMic USB	₹15-20K
Acoustic treatment	DIY foam + closet booth	₹5-10K
Camera (if shooting)	iPhone 15 Pro (already have) or Sony FX3 rental ₹3-5K/day	varies
Lighting	2× Aputure 60d + softbox + reflector	₹60-90K (or rent ₹2K/day)

People (when to hire)

ROLE	HIRE WHEN	COST (₹/ MO)	WHAT THEY UNLOCK
Part-time motion designer (AE)	Month 1	₹15-25K retainer	Polish on top of our code renders. Biggest single ROI.
Strategist + copywriter (you for now)	Month 3	₹30-60K	Hook + script + caption ownership
Producer	Month 6	₹40-80K	Frees creative time
Art Director	Year 2	₹80K-1.5L	Owns visual systems across clients

Templates

Brief template

Saved at `brand-kit/content/_templates/brief.md` — copy + fill.

Script template

Saved at `brand-kit/content/_templates/script.md` — copy + fill.

Storyboard template

Figma file: TBD (create a 9-frame template + duplicate per post).

Asset manifest

For each video, maintain `brand-kit/video/v/_assets/manifest.md` :

```
# v_<name> - Asset Manifest

## AI clips
- `brand_reveal.mp4` - Higgsfield · prompt: "M monogram zooming in, mint gradient, slow dolly"
- `skyline.mp4` - Runway Gen-3 · prompt: "Hyderabad skyline at dusk, anamorphic, 2k, cinematic"

## Stock
- `kitchen-pan.mp4` - Artgrid · clip ID #AG-23847

## Music
- `posts-stay.wav` - Musicbed · "Quiet Engines" by [artist] · License: BM-2026-04

## Fonts
- Plus Jakarta Sans (in brand-kit/fonts/)
- JetBrains Mono (in brand-kit/fonts/)
```

Quality checklist (run before every ship)

Brand

- [] Logo uses `brand-mint-monogram.svg` (don't redraw)
- [] Fonts are Plus Jakarta Sans + JetBrains Mono only
- [] Mint accent is `#10B981` (mint-3) — not a custom green
- [] No founder face content
- [] No invented numbers / unverified stats
- [] No competitor callouts (named or implied)

Composition

- [] All text fits inside `SAFE_TEXT_W = 920px` (no edge bleed)
- [] Top 250px and bottom 340px clear of critical text (IG UI safe zone)
- [] Vertical position of hero text ~50% of frame
- [] Cuts every 1.0-1.8s

Motion

- [] No hard binary on/off animations (use ease curves)
- [] Camera moves are subtle (Ken Burns 1.00 → 1.04 max)
- [] Transitions between beats have continuity (no black flashes unless intentional)

Audio

- [] Master at -14 LUFS
- [] VO at -6 dB peak (if VO present)
- [] Music ducks under VO when applicable
- [] No clipping on whoosh / impact sounds

Delivery

- [] Caption.txt is copy-paste-ready (hashtags at end after `.\n.\n.\n`)
- [] DM keyword is in caps in caption
- [] Cover frame is selected and 1080×1920
- [] Best-time-to-post is honored (per `INSTAGRAM-BRIEF.md`)

File-system reference

```
brand-kit/
├─ BRAND-GUIDELINES.md      # The brand identity rules
├─ INSTAGRAM-BRIEF.md       # The IG content brief (audience, pillars, voice)
├─ PLAYBOOK-VIRAL-REELS.md # 7 viral mechanics + hook formulas
├─ SPACING-GUIDELINES.md    # Canvas safe areas + fit_to_width rules
├─ PRODUCTION-WORKFLOW.md   # ← This document
├─ content/
│   ├─ INSTAGRAM-BRIEF.md    # (same as above, also linked here)
│   ├─ 30-posts/             # Per-post specs (md)
│   └─ posts-ready/          # Per-post ready-to-ship (cover, caption, meta)
├─ fonts/                   # Brand fonts (Plus Jakarta + JetBrains + Inter)
├─ logo/                     # Canonical brand marks (svg)
└─ video/
    ├─ v13-hyderabad-empires/ # Empires series (EP01-04)
    ├─ v14-awareness/         # Awareness reel (no founder, viral mechanics)
    ├─ v15-positioning/       # Agency-manifesto reel
    └─ v16-cinematic/         # Hollywood-tier (60fps, whip-pans, glitch)
```

Where to start (today)

1. Pick a single reel from the 30-post plan to ship this week
2. Fill the brief template (1 hr)

3. Adapt one of v13-v16 build scripts (the code is the storyboard) — 30 min
4. Render + iterate on the hook (the cheapest revision is hook copy) — 30 min
5. Skip VO (cold-start move)
6. Caption-paste, schedule, post
7. Reply to comments for the first hour

That's the whole loop.

This document is versioned with the repo. Update it as the workflow evolves.